

with newbies. But it doesn't mean you can't get your hands dirty with Emacs.

Most people criticise Emacs users for trying to do everything with it, except editing. So let's begin with editing, a task for which Emacs was initially built.

Emacs can handle pretty much any type of file. Just type the following command:

```
$ emacs FileName.ext
```

Emacs also does syntax highlighting and indentation. It usually follows the GNU style of indentation. The best thing about Emacs is that you can customise it the way you want. I usually like the Allman style of indentation when editing C code with four spaces. To change it, add this to your `~/emacs` file.

```
(setq c-default-style "linux"
      c-basic-offset 4)
```

Emacs for back-up

By default, Emacs creates a back-up file for every file it edits. It's usually named as the original file followed by a tilde like `FileName~`. Though back-up files are life savers, they are difficult to manage if they accumulate on the same folder. To save all your files in one place, let's say in the folder `~/saves`, add the following code to your `~/emacs` file.

```
(setq backup-directory-alist ((". " "~/saves")))
```

Emacs for browsing

If you are only interested in the contents of a website and want to avoid the jarring JavaScript, Emacs is the way to go. It uses an extension `w3m.el` that uses `w3m`, which itself is a 'text-browser'. Of course, there is Lynx and other text editors, but `w3m` integrates with Emacs pretty quickly.

```
(add-to-list 'load-path "~/emacs-w3m")
(require 'w3m-load)
(setq browse-url-browser-function 'w3m-browse-url)
(autoload 'w3m-browse-url "w3m" "Ask a WWW browser to show a
URL." t)
;; optional keyboard short-cut
(global-set-key "VC-xm" 'browse-url-at-point)
```

Emacs for e-mail

How about integrating Emacs to view your email (Gmail)? You could do this with GNUS. Add the following command to your `~/gnus` file.

```
(setq gnus-select-method
      '(nnimap "gmail"
              (nnimap-address "imap.gmail.com")
```

```
(nnimap-server-port 993)
(nnimap-stream ssl)))
```

```
(setq message-send-mail-function 'smtpmail-send-it
      smtpmail-starttls-credentials '("smtp.gmail.com"
587 nil nil))
smtpmail-auth-credentials '(("smtp.gmail.com" 587
                             "user@gmail.com" nil))
smtpmail-default-smtp-server "smtp.gmail.com"
smtpmail-smtp-server "smtp.gmail.com"
smtpmail-smtp-service 587
gnus-ignored-newsgroups "^ato\\.\\.\\.\\[0-9. ]+\\(\\(\\$\\)\\|\\^\\[\"\\]\"\\[\"#\"\\]\\)\"))
```

Replace the user with your Gmail username. Also add the following code to your `~/authinfo` file:

```
machine imap.gmail.com login user@gmail.com password
secret port 993
machine smtp.gmail.com login user@gmail.com password
secret port 587
```

The password field is optional. Type `M-x gnus` to start GNUS. To compose an email, type `m`. Press `C-c C-c` to send the mail.

Emacs for photo editing

The other task I usually do is look up a few photos. Emacs can do more than just enable the viewing of pictures. It has an in-built powerful image editor called *Image-Dired*. Simply type `M-x image-dired` on your Emacs.

Emacs for composing documents

This is one of Emacs' features that I find unparalleled.

The official website says, "Org mode is for keeping notes, maintaining TO-DO lists, planning projects, and authoring documents with a fast and effective plain-text system."

If you love *LaTeX*, then there are more reasons to love *org mode*. You could integrate *TeX* support and export your work as a PDF. For this, add the following code to your `~/emacs` file:

```
(require 'org-latex)
(unless (boundp 'org-export-latex-classes)
  (setq org-export-latex-classes nil))
(add-to-list 'org-export-latex-classes
  '("article"
    "\\documentclass{article}"
    "\\section{\\$}" . "\\section*{\\$}"))
```

Emacs for secret writing

If you happen to maintain a personal diary, you must be paranoid about keeping it secret. Emacs could be used